Reading comprehension exercise

You are going to read an article about a student who learns to cook for himself. Six sentences have been removed from the article. Choose from the sentences A-G the one which fits each gap (1-6). There is one extra sentence which you do not need to use.

Cooking at University

For university student Matthew, getting to grips with cooking for himself on his first time away from home was a real learning curve. Now totally at ease in the kitchen, he looks on the experience as literally life-changing.

'To be honest,' Matthew says, 'when I left home for university, I didn't give a great deal of thought to how I would feed myself. At that time I was more concerned with all the other challenges ahead of me, particularly the academic ones, and anyway I knew how to heat up ready meals. 1/…. Especially as I was trying to keep up with difficult new work, and socialising into the small hours with new friends. 1

'At first I couldn't believe that snacking on nothing but junk food and sometimes skipping meals altogether could have serious effects. 2/…. I had much less energy than before.' And, worryingly, he was in bad shape. 'That did it,' he admits. 'After a lifetime of healthy home cooking, I was suddenly living on junk food. My diet and lifestyle were harming my system and I desperately needed to turn things round.' 2

He returned to university equipped with a new pan or two and some cooking lessons from Mum under his belt. 'I decided to eat as much fresh food as possible - not difficult, since I've always enjoyed fruit and vegetables,' says Matthew. 'I took time to seek out the best and cheapest places to shop. 3/…. 3

'These changes, though, didn't cut me off from student life. .1 wanted to enjoy everything about my experience of university - the friends, the new interests and the social side as well as the study that would hopefully ·mark out my career. But it took some reorganising and commitment to set aside time to eat more healthily. 4/…. 4

'Within weeks of changing to a balanced diet of healthy, freshly cooked food, my concentration powers, my energy and my appearance were all improving. Getting organised brings benefits. I got into the habit of preparing double portions for the fridge or freezer. I would buy fish or chicken portions, add vegetables and throw, the whole thing in the oven. 5/…. It's also good to keep a stock of frozen vegetables to save time and to eat wholegrain foods which fill you up for longer. At exam time, when time is really short, and I'm starving, I can make a filling omelette in minutes.' 5

What were the reactions to his new lifestyle? Matthew explains: 'Well, these days it's cool for guys to be interested in cooking. True; there were jokes that I'd let the side down and abandoned student traditions. 6/…. But I learned that if you are on an intensive course - I'm doing engineering - you need to have the strength for study and, hopefully, a social life too.' 6

A I hadn't, of course.
B Cooking it that way saves on pots and washing up, and it's an easy, tasty meal.
C Before long, though, I was getting pretty fed up with eating those and I started to think cooking for myself might be important after all.
D Eating out like that quite often also made a considerable difference.
E On the more positive side, doing all this became easier as time went on.
F But after a few months I made my first visit home, and the family's comments on my unhealthy appearance made me realise it was true.
G In the same way, I got to know the best times to find the freshest items and when to pick up a bargain.

Listening comprehension exercise

You will hear a restaurant chef talking about his work. For questions 1-10, complete the sentences with the words you hear (from 1 to 3 words).

- Max decided to become a professional chef when he saw his (1) _____ cooking.
- His father wanted him to become (2) _____ instead of a chef.
- He started his first job in late (3) _____
- The worst thing working in a hotel was the (4) _____
- He went to work in France because he knew a (5) _____ in Paris.
- In Paris he sometimes cooked meals for (6) _____ and other famous people.
- In his own restaurant, Max always aims to use (7) _____ products.
- Max is particularly proud of the (8) _____ of meals available at his restaurant.
- He says that everything in his restaurant is (9) _____ cooked for the customer.
- On one occasion, all the (10) _____ was stolen on its way to the restaurant.

Vocabulary: Fixed phrases

Replace the underlined words with these fixed phrases (that you have to adapt grammatically).

at first sight **at ease** **break sb's heart** **get on sb's nerves** **to be attracted to**	**keep sb. company** **propose to sb.** **leave sb. alone** **lose touch** **take sb. for granted**

1. When I'm with my best friend Sophie, I feel completely relaxed.
2. He keeps sending me silly text messages and it's starting to annoy me.
3. It's sad when a friend moves away and you stop communicating with them.
4. Louis doesn't seem very intelligent the first time you see him, but he is.
5. From the way Zoe looks at Mark, I think she really likes him.
6. I love Carla and I'm going to ask her to marry me.
7. Those people are annoying me. I want them to stop talking to me.
8. I don't want to be on my own this evening. Will you stay here with me, please?
9. It'll make me very, very sad if you marry somebody else.
10. Sometimes I think Jeff forgets how lucky he is to have me as a friend.

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Gapped text
Practise

A BRIEF ENGAGEMENT

Before she became famous in the 1880's, Emily (1) _____ been engaged to wealthy businessman William Davies. In (2) _____ days, parents often chose their future son-in-law, and when they introduced William to her it was certainly not love at (3) _____ sight.

Although tall and handsome, he was twelve years older than her and, she suspected, rather arrogant. In fact she was not really attracted (4) _____ him at all, but when he proposed to her she accepted rather than upset her parents.

She soon realizes what a huge mistake she (5) _____ made. His bossy, impatient manner quickly started (6) _____ on her nerves, and even when they were out walking together she never felt (7) _____ ease with him.

She tried her best to make the relationship work, but he made no effort at all and she felt he was (8) _____ her for granted.

Eventually, she decided to break (9) _____ her engagement. Some years later, Emily would write that it was the best decision she had ever made.

Writing – article

Before you start writing an article, here are some **linking words**.

Match the underlined linking words with their meanings.

as soon as (see booklet 1)
at first
at the same time
between those two times
immediately
very surprisingly

Your answers:

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.
6.

1. <u>Initially</u>, Jeff thought he was alone. But then he realised there was someone else there.
2. It was 8.30 and the train left at 9.15. <u>In the meantime</u>, I had a coffee.
3. <u>Once</u> Sonia had woken up, she put the light on.
4. The door opened, but <u>to my amazement</u> there was nobody there.
5. The thief broke the car window. <u>Instantly</u>, a loud alarm went off.
6. There was a flash of light and <u>simultaneously</u> a loud noise.

Involve your readers by using expressions like:

Do you ever…? – You might think… - How would you feel if…

TASK (150-200 words)

You have seen the following announcement on an international website for young people:



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Writing · article: your answer (150-200 words)

Title:

Grammar Reference

REVIEW OF PAST TENSES
past simple
past continuous
past perfect
past perfect continuous
used to…
would…

1- Look at these phrases:

a) He was very impressed by the meal I'd made him
b) As a child I used to watch …
c) I would imagine myself cooking something delicious
d) First, I went to college, in 2001
e) I was cooking when you arrived
f) I'd been thinking of going to Paris for a long time before I actually went

Which verb form do we use:

1. for actions or events in the past?
2. to talk about something that was going on when something else happened?
3. when we are already talking about the past and we want to talk about an earlier event?
4. to talk about how long something went on up to a point in the past?
5. to talk, without using time expressions, about things we did regularly in the past but don't do anymore?
6. like 5, but only for actions, not states?

2- Correct the mistakes in the sentences. In some cases, more than one answer is possible.

1. He started walking back to the shop where he left his bike the day before.
2. People saw that Anita cried, but nobody could help her.
3. The street party was something that we organised for weeks before the holidays.
4. I used to be a member of a swimming club for about ten years.
5. We were very surprised as we knew that the house was empty for nearly thirty years.
6. I listened, and it was clear that someone walked across the floor.
7. When you look back, people didn't used to worry about what they ate.
8. I wanted to go to Egypt because I used to decide that I wanted to be an archaeologist.

Grammar Reference · answers

1- Which verb form do we use? (write the tense and/or the example letter a-f)

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.
6.

2- Correct the mistakes in the sentences.

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3- Choose the correct form of the verb (A, B or C) to complete each sentence.

1 I don't think I _____ Holly before last week's party.
A was meeting B met C 'd met

2 My aunt and uncle had no children of their own, so they _____ a baby girl last year.
A adopted B used to adopt C were adopting

3 When I got home last night I felt quite tired because I _____ at the club all evening.
A used to dance B 'd been dancing C danced

4 Sean _____ with somebody else all last summer, but now he's my sister's boyfriend.
A used to go out B had gone out C was going out

5 I was born in July 1983. My mother _____ a widow only two months earlier.
A became B had become C was becoming

6 When I arrived at Micky's house, everyone _____ a film on TV.
A watched B used to watch C was watching

4- Complete the sentences using the PAST TENSES forms explained on p.6

This morning I saw my cousin Emilia while I ...

Nowadays I go on holiday with friends, but when I was younger I ...

My stepbrother was upset and his eyes were red because he ...

I made friends with lots of people when I ...

When we were kids, we often went to birthday parties where we ...

I had a date with Zyta, but I was late and by the time I arrived she ...